# Michael F Bergmann

*Performance, projection, and machine collaboration*

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## Selected Works

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| **2026** | "Before I Was This." Generative text work. flashDRIVE: Digital Arts Fundraiser Exhibition, InterAccess, Toronto, April 22 – May 9, 2026. Curated by Miriam Arbus. |
| **2026** | Nuptials (feature film). Producer, projection design, and live in-camera VFX. Directed by Sean Braune, Para-sight Productions. Official release February 13, 2026 (Freestyle Digital Media). Best World Feature Film, Austin Revolution Film Festival, 2022. |
| **2025** | The Frankenstein Project. Producer, with Debashis Sinha. Performance Studio Theatre, TMU, November 18–22, 2025. |
| **2025** | "To my creators…" Solo work exhibited at the Creative AI Symposium, TMU, April 2, 2025; created during the SÍM residency, Reykjavík. |
| **2024** | Shipwreck. Group exhibition with UKAI Projects and five Canadian artists, SÍM Gallery, Reykjavík, Iceland, following a month-long residency; includes solo work "To my creators…" |
| **2024** | Labour and Us. Workshop series (March 14 – April 17, 2024) and performance, co-created and performed with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson; roundtable with Alan Filewod, Tom Scholte, Cynthia Ashperger, and Judith Thompson. ImprovLab, University of Guelph, April 19, 2024. |
| **2024** | Almost Alchemy. Two 360° video experiences of improvised research-creation performance. RUBIX, TMU, January 25, 2024. |
| **2019** | "The Uncanny Robots Project: Phase 1." Research-creation premiere examining human-robot interaction through dance, commissioned for the opening of the Creative Technology Lab @ FCAD, TMU, October 2019. |
| **2017** | Slaughterhouse/Requiem. Projection design; choreography by Belinda McGuire. Harbourfront NextSteps, Fleck Dance Theatre, Toronto. |
| **2016** | YET. Projection design; choreography by Heidi Strauss. Ryerson Dances, Ryerson Theatre, Toronto. |
| **2014** | He Left Quietly. Projection design; directed by Leora Morris. SummerWorks Performance Festival, Toronto. Best Production, 2014. |
| **2014** | echo::system Action Station #2: The Desert. Video design and system design team; choreography by Grisha Coleman. ACCAD, The Ohio State University. |
| **2014** | TECHknowSELF. Wrote, directed, and designed this multimedia performance (MFA thesis). Becton Engineering Center, Yale University. |

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| **2013 – 2014** | Accidental Death of an Anarchist. Projection design; directed by Christopher Bayes. Yale Repertory Theatre / Berkeley Repertory Theatre. |
| **2013** | Water Closeted (projection installation). Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery. |
| **2012** | On Guard (projection installation). Group showing, Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery. |

## Recent Creative Work

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| **2026** | "Before I Was This." Generative text work. flashDRIVE: Digital Arts Fundraiser Exhibition, InterAccess, Toronto, April 22 – May 9, 2026. Curated by Miriam Arbus. |
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| **2025** | The Frankenstein Project. Producer, with Debashis Sinha. Performance Studio Theatre, TMU, November 18–22, 2025. |
| **2025** | 291 by Jade O'Keeffe. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Lisa Dixon. Peterborough Theatre Guild, November 1–15, 2025. |
| **2025** | "To my creators…" Solo work exhibited at the Creative AI Symposium, TMU, April 2, 2025; created during the SÍM residency, Reykjavík. |
| **2024** | AVARA 2024 installation. Led eight students in a semester-long research-creation installation presented at AVARA 2024, OAMK, Oulu, Finland. |
| **2024** | Shipwreck. Group exhibition with UKAI Projects and five Canadian artists, SÍM Gallery, Reykjavík, Iceland, following a month-long residency; includes solo work "To my creators…" |
| **2024** | Labour and Us. Workshop series (March 14 – April 17, 2024) and performance, co-created and performed with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson; roundtable with Alan Filewod, Tom Scholte, Cynthia Ashperger, and Judith Thompson. ImprovLab, University of Guelph, April 19, 2024. |
| **2024** | Almost Alchemy. Two 360° video experiences of improvised research-creation performance. RUBIX, TMU, January 25, 2024. |
| **2023** | "rocketmanperson." Improvised performance with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson. Silence, Guelph, October 1, 2023. |
| **2023** | "Who's There?" Improvised performance with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson. Silence, Guelph, April 1, 2023. |
| **2023** | Living Newspaper 2.0. Projection design; directed by Julie Labagnara. George Luscombe Theatre, Toronto. |

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| **2019** | "The Uncanny Robots Project: Phase 1." Research-creation premiere examining human-robot interaction through dance, commissioned for the opening of the Creative Technology Lab @ FCAD, TMU, October 2019. |

## Residencies

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| **2025 – 2026** | Mentor, Setsubun Digital Media Residency, Japanese Canadian Cultural Centre, Toronto |
| **2024** | Artist-in-residence, SÍM Residency (with UKAI Projects), Reykjavík, Iceland — Shipwreck, June 2–30, 2024 |
| **2022** | Artist-in-residence, Ingenuity Labs Research Institute, Queen's University, Kingston |
| **2021 – 2022** | Ferment AI Residency artist; residency output presented in Berlin, October 2022 |
| **2014** | Artist-in-residence, Ross Creek Centre for the Arts, NS — Incorporeus |
| **2014** | Workshop residency, ACCAD, The Ohio State University — echo::system Action Station #2: The Desert |

## Awards

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| **2022** | Best World Feature Film: Nuptials, Austin Revolution Film Festival (as producer) |
| **2014** | Best Production: He Left Quietly, SummerWorks Performance Festival (as designer) |
| **2012 – 2014** | Eldon Elder Fellowship, Yale University ($40,000 USD; held throughout the MFA) |
| **2009** | Spirit of the Fringe, Prague Fringe Festival |
| **2006** | Short-listed, Prix Molière, Theatre Glendon |

## Grants and Fellowships

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| **2024** | Erasmus+ staff mobility funding, OAMK, Oulu, Finland |
| **2024** | The Creative School Travel Grant, TMU — Shipwreck Iceland project. $1,000. |
| **2022** | TMU Work Study RA Program — "Mechanical Waves: Machine Learning gesture reactive human-robot installation." $3,800. |
| **2021** | SSHRC Partnership Engage Grant, COVID-19 Special Initiative — "Visual Music: Enhancing the National Arts Centre Orchestra's remote connection with their audience during COVID-19 social restrictions through innovative digital tools." PI: Cintia Cristiá; Co-Is: Michael Bergmann, David Bouchard. $24,620. |

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| **2019** | Cirque du Soleil Entertainment Group / Future of Live Entertainment Lab — "l'automate: Expanding the possibility of performance through robotics." Co-I with Jonathon Anderson. $7,500. |
| **2019** | FCAD Special Seed Grant — The Uncanny Robots Project. $4,000. |
| **2018** | Undergraduate Research Opportunity, OVPRI, Ryerson — "Augmented-Reality based Pre-Visualization system for theatrical spaces." $9,888. |
| **2018** | Learning and Teaching Enhancement Fund, Ryerson — "The Creative Laboratory Project." Co-I with Pavlo Bosyy. $13,000. |
| **2012 – 2014** | Eldon Elder Fellowship, Yale University. $40,000 USD. |

## Projection and Installation Design

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| **2019** | Crossing Borders. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Gill Foster. International Arts Youth Festival, Kingston upon Thames, UK. |
| **2019** | Foreign Tongue. Projection design; directed by Cynthia Ashperger. NextStage Festival, Toronto. |
| **2018** | Nuptials (feature film). Projection design and live in-camera VFX; directed by Sean Braune. Para-sight Productions. (Released 2026; see Creative Research Output.) |
| **2018** | Crossing Borders. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Peggy Shannon and Gill Foster. Parodos Festival, Toronto. |
| **2018** | 291. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Rebecca Ballarin. Parodos Festival, Toronto. |
| **2017** | Slaughterhouse/Requiem. Projection design; choreography by Belinda McGuire. Harbourfront NextSteps, Fleck Dance Theatre, Toronto. |
| **2016** | YET. Projection design; choreography by Heidi Strauss. Ryerson Dances, Ryerson Theatre, Toronto. |
| **2016** | Slaughterhouse/Requiem. Projection design; choreography by Belinda McGuire. Belinda McGuire Dance Projects. |
| **2014** | Incorporeus. Projection design; choreography by Belinda McGuire. Belinda McGuire Dance Projects. |
| **2014** | He Left Quietly. Projection design; directed by Leora Morris. SummerWorks Performance Festival, Toronto. Best Production, 2014. |
| **2014** | echo::system Action Station #2: The Desert. Video design and system design team; choreography by Grisha Coleman. ACCAD, The Ohio State University. |
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| **2013 – 2014** | Accidental Death of an Anarchist. Projection design; directed by Christopher Bayes. Yale Repertory Theatre / Berkeley Repertory Theatre. |

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| **2013** | Water Closeted (projection installation). Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery. |
| **2013** | AlgoRhythym. Visual component for Matt Otto's sound performance thesis. Yale School of Drama. |
| **2012** | Iphigenia Among the Stars. Projection design; directed by Jack Tamburri. Yale School of Drama. |
| **2012** | Fox Play. Projection design; directed by Lileana Blain-Cruz. Yale School of Drama. |
| **2012** | Dracula. Projection design; directed by Jack Tamburri. Yale Cabaret. |
| **2012** | On Guard (projection installation). Group showing, Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery. |
| **2011** | Creation 2011. Projection design; directed by Sarah Krasnow. Yale Cabaret. |
| **2010** | Leer. Projection design. BergARTS, Toronto. |
| **2006** | Terre Rouge. Projection design; directed by Guillaume Bernardi. Theatre Glendon, Toronto. |
| **2006** | The Marriage of Bette and Boo. Projection design; directed by Mel Couture. Theatre Glendon, Toronto. |

## Direction, Lighting, and Film

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| **2010** | Leer. Direction. BergARTS, Toronto. |
| **2010** | Three Sisters. Assistant direction; directed by Cynthia Ashperger. Ryerson Theatre (Abrams), Toronto. |
| **2010** | The Centre of Everything Civilized. Lighting design; directed by John Jack Patterson. Toronto Fringe Festival. |
| **2010** | WET. Lighting design; directed by John Jack Patterson. Toronto Fringe Festival. |
| **2009** | This Still Night. Co-direction with Meghan Gennings. Prague Fringe Festival. Spirit of the Fringe award, 2009. |
| **2009** | Mother Courage. Assistant direction; directed by Richard Greenblatt. Ryerson Theatre, Toronto. |
| **2009** | A Summer's Day. Lighting design; directed by Cynthia Ashperger. Alley Theatre, Toronto. |
| **2009** | A Glendale Christmas. Lighting design; directed by Tom Haxell. Hamilton Fringe Festival. |
| **2009** | Blood Buds. Lighting design; directed by Barbara Johnston. Ryerson Theatre (Abrams), Toronto. |
| **2009** | Le Nez. Lighting design; directed by Rebecca Vandevelde. Theatre Glendon, Toronto. |
| **2009** | An Encounter (short). Cinematography and editing. Roving Eye Productions. |

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| **2009** | Transmigration (short). Cinematography and editing. Bergmann & Braune. |
| **2008** | LOFT Christmas Concert. Lighting design. St. James Cathedral, Toronto. |
| **2008** | Romeo & Juliet. Lighting design; directed by Ian Watson. Ryerson Theatre (Abrams), Toronto. |
| **2007** | Koi-san. Direction. Theatre Glendon, Toronto. |
| **2006** | Chimera: A Telling of Jekyll and Hyde. Direction. Theatre Glendon, Toronto. |
| **2005** | Most Guys Today (feature). Cinematography and editing. Greek Chorus Productions. |
| **2004** | Who Goes to Movies? (short). Cinematography and editing. Hammergate Productions. |
| **2003** | Blind Hindsight (short). Cinematography and editing. Bergmann & Braune. |

## Collectives and Affiliations

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| **2025 – present** | Canadian Artificial Intelligence Association |
| **2023 – present** | Almost Alchemy — improvised, multi-disciplinary performance collective (founding member) |
| **2022 – 2023** | Synectic Assembly — AI-driven art collective (founding member) |
| **2021 – 2022** | Diagonal — speaker series and reading group, BMO Lab, University of Toronto |
| **2019 – present** | United States Institute for Theatre Technology (USITT) |
| **2018 – present** | Associated Designers of Canada / IATSE Local ADC 659 |
| **2018 – present** | Canadian Institute for Theatre Technology (CITT) |

## Selected Press

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| **2023** | "Get the inside scoop on game-changing innovations in augmented reality with the new VisionPro." The Creative School Top 5, July 4, 2023. |
| **2023** | Faculty Spotlight: Michael F Bergmann. Performance at The Creative School, June 27, 2023. |
| **2022** | "Students Are Excited And Hopeful For What The Metaverse May Bring." The Eyeopener, October 5, 2022. |
| **2022** | "Michael F. Bergmann On The Merging of Live Arts and Technology." Toronto Life, April 29, 2022. |
| **2021** | "Emerging technology that's here to stay." CityNews Toronto, June 18, 2021. |

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| **2020** | “Can you feel empathy for a dancing robot?” Ryerson Innovation Magazine, Issue 33, 2020. |
| **2020** | “FCAD students embrace opportunity to redefine performance.” Nicole Bartnicki, Ryerson University, May 2020. |
| **2019** | “Premiere of robot dance performance launches Creative Technology Lab.” Ryerson University, November 2019. |
| **2015** | Q&A Personal interview, Meghan Perkins, Live Design Magazine, 2015. |

## Education

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| **2022 – present** | PhD Candidate, Critical Studies in Improvisation, University of Guelph. Expected 2027. |
| **2011 – 2014** | MFA, Design (Projection Design Specialization), Yale School of Drama, Yale University |
| **2006 – 2011** | BFA, Theatre Performance Production, Ryerson Theatre School, Toronto Metropolitan University (coursework completed December 2010; graduated May 2011) |